

No reposting on Instagram

Instagram has reportedly denied that it is testing any reposting feature. <https://dgit.in/oct-18-35-1>



Amazon ecosystem ready

With devices like Alexa Microwave, Echo Wall Clock, and Ring Security Camera, Amazon is all set with its Alexa ecosystem. <https://dgit.in/oct-18-35-2>

- Mozilla Firefox Rocket 3.2.0 (7061)
- Flynx 2.1.2
- Ghostery Privacy Browser 2.0.6
- Kiwi Browser (version Quenepa)
- Maxthon Browser 5.2.3.3235
- Microsoft Edge 42.0.0.2540
- Opera Browser 47.3.2249.130976
- Opera Mini 36.2.2254.130496
- Opera Touch 1.10.3
- Puffin Browser 7.7.1.30436
- Tor Browser for Android 60.2.0
- UC Browser 12.9.2.1143
- UC Mini 11.5.2

TEST DEVICE AND ENVIRONMENT

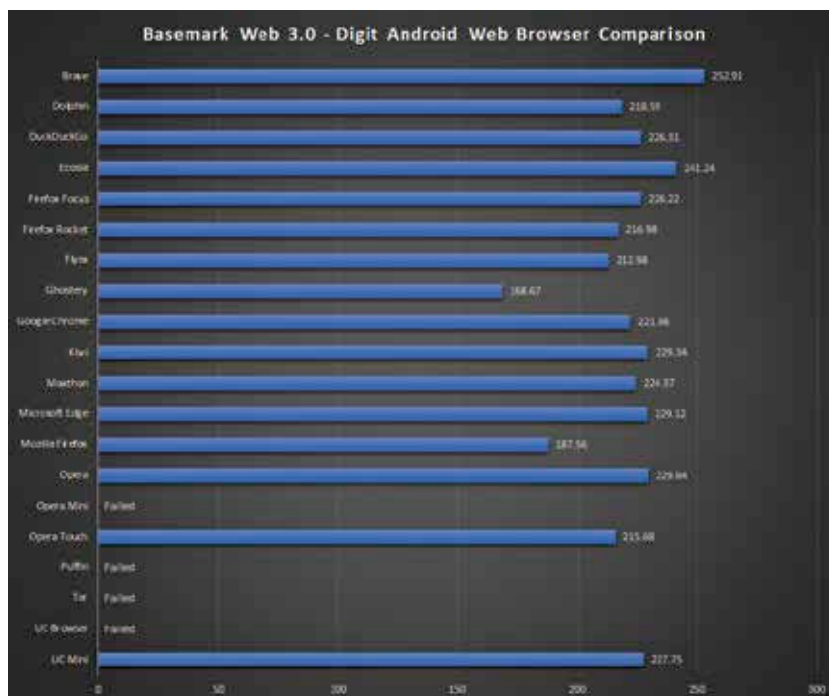
We wanted the browser tests to be objective. Hence, we used two Android devices for this test. We used the OnePlus 5T and Xiaomi Mi 5. The OnePlus 5T was running on its stock OxygenOS 5.1.5 and Android Oreo 8.1.0. In its stock condition, it would give us a better representation of the browser performance. Powered by the Snapdragon 835 with 8GB RAM, this phone would cover the performance experienced on a high-end device. On the Xiaomi Mi 5, we got rid of the bloated MIUI ROM and flashed a custom ROM called Pixel Experience, running on Android Oreo 8.1.0. The Mi 5 is an older-generation device running on a Snapdragon 820 with only 3 GB of RAM. So, this device will be able to reflect browser performance on a device with comparatively lower RAM.

Both the devices were factory reset and all the latest OS updates were installed including security updates. Apart from the browsers being tested, no other apps were installed on them. This ensured that there weren't many apps running in the background apart from the system apps. In our scoring, both the device's scores were considered. All the devices were connected to the same Wi-Fi network with 100 Mbps throughput to ensure a standard internet connection for all the tests.

TESTING METHODOLOGY

Overall performance

Our goal was to test the best web browser on Android that offered the best performance. So, we used three



Benchmarks obtained on the OnePlus 5T

benchmarking suites including Basemark Web 3.0, Dromaeo and Speedometer 2.0 to cover various aspects of a browser's capabilities.

Basemark Web 3.0 does an overall browser benchmark to test the performance of several real-world scenarios. The performance test runs ECMAScript and JavaScript apps, WebGL 2.0 renders, JavaScript frameworks including jQuery, Angular and Backbone, Document Object Model (DOM) and CSS features. Therefore, this benchmark will be able to determine how well the browser handles system tests and graphics across many parameters. As this test is a little intensive with the WebGL 2.0 graphical iterations, some browsers might run too slow and in worst cases, crash.

Although Basemark Web 3.0 takes care of testing JavaScript to an extent, Mozilla's own Dromaeo suite does a more extensive test. When web browsers are tested, you'd usually find SunSpider and V8 JavaScript tests being covered in them. These two are currently not being maintained actively but they are still capable enough of testing your browser. Along with these two tests, Dromaeo employs its own set of JavaScript tests in this suite.

It can also run DOM and CSS Selector tests but those are already taken care of to an extent by Basemark Web 3.0 and Speedometer 2.0. In Dromaeo, we ran only the JavaScript tests to observe the core JavaScript performance.

Speedometer 2.0 by BrowserBench is an extensive benchmark that runs tests to check how well the browser supports web applications. Several of these web apps are based on user interactions coming from the keyboard and touch input, and all the interactions are simulated. It uses applications based on ECMAScript and JavaScript. Your browser's performance depends on factors including DOM APIs, JavaScript engine, CSS style resolution and others. The score is calculated based on the number of the app runs completed under a minute and the same set of apps are repeated 10 times to generate an average or arithmetic mean. Higher the score, better the performance.

Before running a benchmark, the browser's data was cleared. This made sure that there wasn't any saved data from the previous web pages which might affect the benchmarks. The phone's memory cache was also wiped after every benchmark and